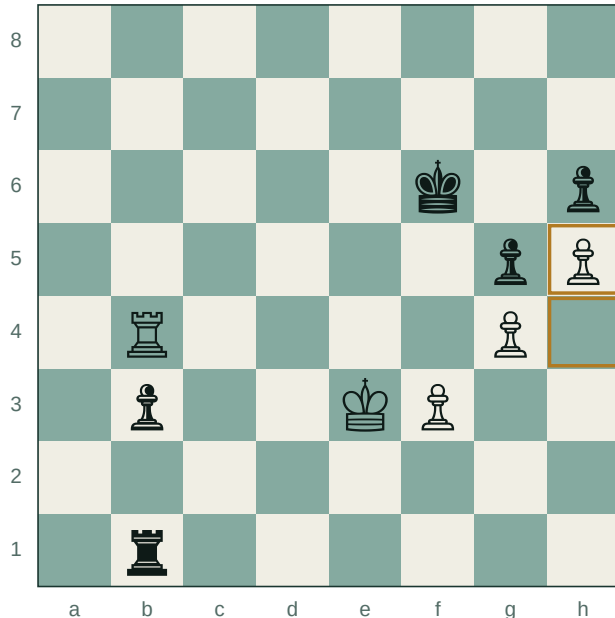


Active defensive resources: Black, move 43

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 43.h5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43...b2 44. Rb6+ Ke5 45. f4+ gxf4+

43...b2 The pawn moves from b3 to b2. Recorded reply: **44.Rb6+**.

44...Ke5 The king moves from f6 to e5. Recorded reply: **45.f4+**.

45...gxf4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e3. Geometrically undefended: rook on b4. Check for tactical protection.